Paratah Prakasha (non-reflexivity of consciousness): this is the view that a cognitive state is not known to the subject immediately upon its occurrence. The ***Nyaya-Vaisheshikas*** and *Bhatta Mimamsakas* (see ***Kumarila***) deny that conscious states, which are exclusively defined in terms of the manifestation of objects external to the mind, are intrinsically reflexive or self-revealing (***svayam prakasha***). The ***Nyaya*** holds that a perceptual state may be revealed once it has occurred by another perceptual state (***anuvyavasaya***). The standard objections to this position are that it involves an infinite regress and that dependence upon an extraneous factor for illumination is a common characteristic of the inert. The ultra-realist followers of ***Kumarila*** say that cognitions, in themselves formless and receptive, are acts (*kriya*) which produce the temporary property of being known (***jnatata***) in the external object. We know that cognition has occurred by inference from this effect not by introspection.

Further reading: Matilal 1986

Paratah pramanya: ***Nyaya*** philosophers hold that a cognition is true when it corresponds to some reality external to the mind. They recognise that we cannot check the truth of a cognition by stepping outside ourselves and comparing our thoughts with objective reality. We need some other form of testing, such as successful activity following the cognition which reveals its truth. So they make a distinction between the origins of a belief and what makes it true. Truth stands in need of confirmation, it is not self-evident. We infer that a cognition was true on the basis of its having generated successful practice. So knowledge is not transparently true. The objection to this is that the confirmatory awareness stands in need of confirmation and so on. The ***Nyaya*** response is that the experience of success is sufficient to check the need for further corroboration.